

NICOLAS VANA

Game Designer • Programmer • Project Manager

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SUMMARY

Technical Game Designer and Producer focused on gameplay systems, state machines, and managing QA pipelines. Proven track record of leading interdisciplinary teams to develop full feature pipelines and deliver complex gameplay logic in Unity (C#) and Unreal Engine (C++). Experienced in managing the entire testing lifecycle, from creating test plans and bug tracking to data- and telemetry-driven iteration.

CORE SKILLS

- **Technical Design & Programming:** Unity C#, Unreal Engine C++, state machines, and rapid prototype scripting.
- **Gameplay & System Design:** Core loop design, pacing, audiovisual reward systems, and data-driven balancing.
- **QA & Project Management:** Scrum facilitation, ownership of the playtesting pipeline, bug tracking (Airtable / Notion / Jira), and technical documentation.
- **Production & Tools:** Version control (Git / Perforce), Excel, backlog management, and interdisciplinary communication.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Producer & Programmer | Eskentert Productions – “Jump Quest Online”

Since Oct. 2025

- **Project Leadership & Business Development:** Leading a team of 4; responsible for project planning (scheduling), developing financing strategies, and shaping the business model.
- **Gameplay Programming & Performance:** Independently developing and implementing all game mechanics as well as in-depth performance optimization.
- **Network & Server Architecture:** Building the server-client communication and developing the netcode, designed for a scalable multiplayer environment (MMO scenario).

Lead Game Designer & Co-Founder | reignite games – “Panta Rhei”

Aug. 2022 – Sep. 2025

- **Technical & AI Design:** Built the complete production pipeline for enemies; conceived and implemented 9 distinct enemy types with unique AI behaviors and attack patterns.
- **Core Mechanics:** Designed and prototyped the core gameplay loop and 4 distinct interactive mechanics; ensured seamless technical integration between design and code.
- **QA Management:** Owned the entire playtesting pipeline; developed comprehensive test plans and managed bug tracking and feedback via Airtable to drive iterative design.
- **Leadership:** Led a 7-person interdisciplinary team, managed the design backlog, and facilitated weekly Scrum meetings to hit milestones.

Puzzle Game Design Intern | ClockStone – “LEGO Bricktales”

Aug. 2021 – Mar. 2022

- **Systematic Design:** Conceptualized 15+ gameplay setups and iterated on 25+ variations in Unity to refine player guidance, engagement, and pacing curves.
- **Quality Assurance:** Managed the playtesting pipeline; consolidated feedback from 10+ playtesters into actionable QoL improvements.

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

Hot Noon — *Producer & Programmer (Unity)*

- Sole programmer for gameplay, local multiplayer input, and UI/UX; concurrently led a team of 3 from prototype to release.

Orbi'dashu — *Game Design & Engine Programmer (Custom C++ Engine)*

- Co-developed a 2D arcade game on a custom C++ engine; implemented the core game loop, full player interaction, the UI, and contributed to foundational engine systems.

Reech & Hait — *Project Lead & Programmer (MonoGame)*

- Designed interdependent mechanics and programmed interactive features, system states, and UI from concept to release.

EDUCATION, LANGUAGES & TOOLS

Education

MA – MultiMedia Art (Management & Producing)
FH Salzburg, 2025

BSc – MultiMedia Technology (Game)
FH Salzburg, 2022

Languages

German (native) • English (C1) • French (A2) •
Japanese (A1)

Tools & Technologies

Engines: Unity, Unreal Engine 5

Programming: C#, C++

Management & QA: Airtable, Notion, Jira, Miro,
Milanote, Confluence, Scrum/Agile

Version Control: Git, Perforce